

It's a V22 Osprey! It's a Sea Harrier!

Not just another drone

You're probably wondering what a V22 Osprey and Sea Harrier are. The two names are used interchangeably for a helicopter and plane rolled into one. This fighter aircraft, that can take off vertically, is used by the Indian and British Navy, respectively (they also happen to be birds...sort of). Why they have a place in this section has everything to do with yet another drone. While we're used to seeing several quadcopters on tech websites and magazines, they're pretty slow and don't look as cool when they fly, unlike drones that take on the shape of a conventional aircraft. Sadly, for these drones to work, you need a landing strip for takeoff and landing.

Well, that problem has been identified and solved. The aircraft is available for pre-order on Kickstarter. Developed by Krossblade Aerosystems (yes, that's a very cool name), the SkyProwler (an even more badass name) is a "high-performance, multi-mission, VTOL Transformer Drone (we don't know what that last bit means, but we're listening intently).

VTOL stands for 'Vertical Take-Off and Landing', meaning the SkyProwler can take off like a helicopter and fly away like a



jet. It comes with an internally balanced action cam that shoots 4K video at 30 fps. According to its Kickstarter page, you can also control the SkyProwler using your voice and the GPS coordinates of your controller. You can pre-order your almost-ready-to-fly kit with no video or radio for \$479 (₹29,829 – early bird) or spend \$1,479 (₹92,089) and fly this baby straight out of the box.

SPECIFICATIONS

Price: ₹18,500 (\$299) | **Bluetooth Profile:** Human Interface
Battery: 3 cell Li-ion 5000 mAh | **Top Speed:** 134 kmph
Endurance: up to 40 minutes | **Range:** up to 69 km.



Sophia

Sophia, a Kickstarter project, is an attempt to make rope-jumping interesting by interfacing with a sports tracking app. It connects to your Android or iOS smartphone through Bluetooth, using a companion app that integrates with Google Fit or iOS HealthKit. And as the trend goes, the app has a social element which means you can challenge your friends to a game of skipping and post to social networks your workout stats.

The handles of the skipping rope contain a triaxial accelerometer and an optical module, which supposedly count the number of jumps with high-precision. The team behind Sophia, FitFox Ltd., claim to have re-engineered the classic handles of a skipping rope, resulting in an ergonomic handle that fit perfectly in your hands. The device might sound too fancy, but hey, why not.

SPECIFICATIONS

Price: TBA | **Grip Material:** Leather | **Cord Material:** High-quality polymer | **Display type:** OLED | **Weight:** 164 g | **Battery Life:** One month @30min/day